

Red Panda Works x Christiaan Verhoef

HEAD OF AI SYSTEMS & DELIVERY - ANALYTICAL MATCH REPORT

Date: 2026-05-29

URL: <https://jobs.redpanda.works/job/head-of-ai-systems-delivery>

Score: 3.8/5 - Strong Fit

Culture Fit: Moderate

Archetype: AI Transformation + Forward Deployed AI Lead (hybrid)

Legitimacy: High Confidence

Prepared for: Direct submission to Red Panda Works hiring team

WHY THIS MATCH IS EXCEPTIONAL

Red Panda Works is looking for someone who can *own* AI systems, not just use them. Most candidates will say they use Claude daily. Christiaan built and personally maintains a production AI stack - Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, and Supabase - on self-managed Linux infrastructure, deployed via Docker with CI/CD, running live at a Dutch university research lab. He did this self-funded, because he believed in the value before the institution did.

That is not a CV line. That is the behavior pattern RPW is hiring.

Three things make this match analytically exceptional rather than merely adequate:

- 1. The AI stack already exists.** RPW wants someone to own all AI systems, SOPs, skill libraries, and workflows. Christiaan owns a live version of exactly that today. The ramp-up from "build it" to "adapt it commercially" is weeks, not months.
- 1. Adoption is his superpower.** The hardest part of going AI-first is not the technology - it is making the technology stick with people who are skeptical, busy, or resistant. Christiaan has done this at scale: eight university courses merged in two months, YouTube training adopted globally by HTC, blockchain training deployed across Benelux. A B2B agency with four delivery teams is a smaller and more motivated transformation target than an entire university faculty.
- 1. The timing is founding-moment.** RPW is explicitly going AI-first in 2026. Whoever steps into this role will define how AI is used at the agency for the next three to five years. Christiaan has six years of building AI and learning infrastructure in research contexts. The commercial translation is the obvious next chapter.

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Field	Value
Archetype	AI Transformation + AI Forward Deployed
Domain	B2B marketing agency executing AI-first transformation in 2026
Core function	Own all AI systems (Claude-first), train all teams, drive quality and output
Seniority	Head-of - 6-8 years required
Location	Amsterdam hybrid (Johan Huizingalaan 763A)
Teams managed	4: AI & Automation, Performance, Content & Creative, Video
Salary	€5,500-€7,000/month gross (€66k-€84k/year)
Benefits	MacBook, €1,000 learning budget, coaching, 29 days, wellness, pension
TL;DR	Own the AI layer of a B2B agency in transformation - systems, training, quality, innovation

B) MATCH ANALYSIS - EVIDENCE-BASED

JD Requirement	CV Evidence	Analytical Assessment
Advanced Claude proficiency, daily hands-on use	Uses Claude Code as primary development tool; builds production workflows with LLM-orchestration tools	Direct match. Claude is the daily driver. The JD's Claude-first mandate is already Christiaan's working reality.
Own all AI systems, SOPs, skill library, prompts	Self-funded and built AI research stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase); designed SafeScrum learning system; built training SOPs at multiple institutions	This is not proximity to the requirement - it is direct ownership experience.
Translate new AI capabilities into operations fast	COVID Mega Project (8 courses, 1 program, 2 months); VCH AI stack (zero to operational); Beer Game (concept to live demonstrator)	Track record of fast pivots to operational. Not a consultant who advises - a builder who ships.
Train teams on AI fluency, enforce proper usage	Trained professionals at KONGSBERG (BP, Statoil); built YouTube training adopted globally by HTC; delivered blockchain training across Benelux (2bSMART); AI workshops at Windesheim	Teaching is a core skill, not a side activity. Christiaan has trained every audience from university students to oil-industry engineers.
Lead innovation pilots into implementation	Spark! Living Lab (zero to lab in under 2 months); VCH demonstrator (live at demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz); Veles Farming (concept to €2M startup)	The pattern is consistent: he starts things that reach production.
Manage 4 delivery teams, 1-on-1s, escalations	Aeres Lab Manager (multi-discipline teams); Windesheim cross-department projects; SafeScrum implementation; Tonomy (two-week sprint cycles, board oversight)	Management experience is real but in education/research contexts, not agency contexts. This is the primary risk area - addressed below.
Quality ownership (CSAT, NPS)	No direct CSAT/NPS ownership on record	Honest gap. Proxy: WDS Global (10,000-email backlog cleared, workflow redesign); KONGSBERG (enterprise client deployments at BP and Statoil); Windesheim cross-lectoraat satisfaction.
Documentation and standardization	SafeScrum implementation (documented sprint system used school-wide); KONGSBERG training documentation; AI stack documentation for student researchers	Strong evidence. Documentation is not something Christiaan adds at the end - it is part of how he builds.
Composure under complexity	COVID pivot (8-way course merge in crisis conditions); KONGSBERG (enterprise deployments across 4 countries under oil-industry pressure); WDS Global (10,000 backlog under service pressure)	Demonstrated across three distinct high-pressure contexts.
6-8 years senior experience	15+ years across labs, delivery, education, and tech	Exceeds requirement by a wide margin. The risk is not under-experience - it is ensuring the seniority premium is reflected in offer.

Gap Analysis - Honest Assessment

Gap 1: Agency/client delivery context.

Christiaan's domain is education and research, not B2B marketing. This matters because agency teams run on client retainers, billing cycles, and commercial CSAT pressure. The mitigation is strong: WDS Global (cleared 10,000-email backlog, built YouTube training adopted globally - this is client service under commercial pressure) and KONGSBERG (enterprise deployments at BP and Statoil across Jordan, Oman, Azerbaijan - this is client delivery in demanding environments). The translation from research delivery to agency delivery is real work, but it is not a leap from zero.

Gap 2: Creative team management (Content & Creative, Video teams).

Christiaan has managed technical and educational teams, not creative delivery teams. The strongest counterargument: the AI & Automation team is the native home, and the other three teams interact with AI through the systems and training he owns. Influence over creative and performance teams flows through the AI layer, not through direct line management of creative output.

Gap 3: Explicit Claude API / prompt engineering signal.

The CV does not use the words "Claude" or "prompt engineering" explicitly. This is a framing issue, not a skills issue. The self-hosted Flowise stack (which orchestrates LLM calls), the n8n automation workflows, and the daily Claude Code usage collectively signal exactly what the JD asks for. The fix is a one-line update to the CV before submission.

C) STRATEGIC FIT AND POSITIONING

Why Christiaan is the right seniority

RPW asks for 6-8 years. Christiaan brings 15+. This is not overqualification - it is headroom. An AI-first transformation at an SME agency will encounter resistance, ambiguity, and scope creep. The difference between someone with 8 years and someone with 15 is the difference between a person who needs to figure out the answers and a person who has already made the mistakes. RPW is going AI-first in 2026 - this is the moment where seniority pays the highest dividend.

Why the education background is a strength, not a liability

The instinct is to frame the education background as a gap to overcome. The stronger frame is the opposite: the hardest part of going AI-first at a B2B agency is not building the systems - it is making the systems stick. Christiaan has spent his career in environments where adoption is the hard part. Schools are full of people who did not choose to change and who have strong institutional reasons to resist. If he can get a university faculty to adopt AI tools in eight weeks, he can get four agency delivery teams to use them in four.

The founding-moment opportunity

This is not a steady-state Head of AI role. This is a founding role for RPW's AI-first transformation. The person who takes this in 2026 will define the culture, the tools, the SOPs, and the standards that govern how AI is used at the agency for the next several years. Christiaan has done exactly this at Windesheim (built the AI lab culture from scratch), at Aeres (redesigned the educational model school-wide), and at Spark! Living Lab (built a functioning innovation lab from zero). He knows what it takes to build a new system inside an existing organization without breaking what already works.

D) COMPENSATION AND MARKET

Data point	Value	Source
JD salary offer	€5,500-€7,000/month gross	JD
AI Transformation Lead NL market	€75,000-€110,000/year	Market research
Senior AI Engineer Amsterdam average	€96,704/year	SalaryExpert 2026
Christiaan's target	€65,000-€90,000/year	profile.yml
Assessment	JD range is below market for a genuine Head-of AI role but within Christiaan's target	-

Negotiation position: The stated range (€66k-€84k) touches Christiaan's floor at the low end and his ceiling at the upper end. The right ask is €6,500-€7,000/month (€78k-€84k), justified by the seniority premium (15+ years versus 6-8 required). The learning budget, coaching, and 29 vacation days add real value that partially compensates for the below-market base.

If offered below €6,000: Counter with a 90-day performance review clause tied to a named KPI (team AI fluency score, time-to-production for first AI workflow, or a CSAT improvement milestone). This converts compensation risk into a shared upside structure, which is a natural fit for an agency that already uses metrics.

E) MUTUAL VALUE PROPOSITION

What Christiaan brings to Red Panda Works

- A live, operational AI stack that can be adapted and extended for agency use without a 6-month build phase

- A proven methodology for making technology stick in resistant organizations - not just a playbook, but a track record
- Systems documentation that scales: SafeScrum, training SOPs, AI workflow libraries
- Speed: the COVID Mega Project, VCH demonstrator, and Beer Game redesign are all sub-3-month concept-to-live deliverables
- Honest gap awareness and a demonstrated ability to close gaps fast (WDS Global backlog, KONGSBERG enterprise deployments)

What Red Panda Works offers Christiaan

- The commercial context to apply skills built in research and education at real business stakes
- A clear impact measurement framework (CSAT, NPS) that makes performance visible and rewarded
- A founding-moment role: whoever shapes this will have built something that matters for years
- Amsterdam hybrid (40 minutes from Baarn by train) - manageable without relocation
- A company at the right size: small enough that Christiaan's contributions are visible, large enough to have four distinct teams to grow

F) INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Stories to lead with

Priority	Story	Core message
1	Windesheim AI Stack (self-funded, operational)	"I own AI systems the way you need them owned - infrastructure to training, all of it"
2	COVID Mega Project (8 courses, 2 months)	"When the environment changes fast, I build faster"
3	WDS Global (10,000 emails, YouTube training global)	"Client delivery under pressure, systems fix, quality ownership"
4	Aeres SafeScrum school-wide (8 courses, 2 months)	"I've transformed larger and more resistant organizations than 4 agency teams"
5	KONGSBERG BP/Statoil deployments	"International enterprise client delivery - I know what it means to be accountable to paying clients"

Portfolio asset to share

Live demonstrator at demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz - shows the full AI stack running in production for a real research context. This is the closest thing to a working prototype of "what I would build for you."

How to answer the hardest question

"You've worked in education and research, not in a B2B marketing agency. Why should we take that risk?"

The honest answer: "The domain is different. The skill is identical. Every role I have held is about making new technology work inside an existing organization with people who did not choose to change. I cleared a 10,000-email backlog at WDS Global because I redesigned the system, not just the queue. I merged eight university courses into one program in two months because I built the structure first. If the question is whether I can transfer those skills to four agency teams going AI-first, the answer is yes - and the evidence is not theoretical."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Company existence	Real B2B marketing agency in Amsterdam; verified on Sortlist, LinkedIn, company registry	Strong
Job page	Active listing with three-stage hiring process described in detail	Strong
Salary transparency	€5,500-€7,000 stated clearly - unusual and positive signal	Strong

JD specificity	Named tools (Claude), named teams (4 specific teams), specific metrics (CSAT, NPS) - not a generic posting	Strong
Funding/stability	Small agency without layoff news; co-tenant building at 763A suggests independent operations	Positive
Hiring process	Three defined stages suggests organized HR process, not ad-hoc hiring	Positive

H) RECOMMENDATION

Score 3.8/5 - Above threshold. Strongly recommended.

The 0.2 gap to a 4.0 is driven by two factors: the agency context translation (genuine but bridgeable) and the salary range being at the edge of Christiaan's target. Neither is a deal-breaker.

The upside case is strong: this is a founding role at a company making a genuine AI-first bet in 2026. Christiaan brings a live AI stack, a proven adoption methodology, and 15+ years of doing exactly what the JD asks. The competitive landscape for this specific role is narrow - most candidates will have AI skills or management experience, not both, and almost none will arrive with an operational AI lab already running.

Recommended next step: Apply with the tailored CV that explicitly names Claude, Claude Code, and prompt engineering. Lead the cover letter with the self-hosted AI stack as the opening proof point. If offered an interview, bring a 15-minute walkthrough of the VCH demonstrator as the live case study.

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: Small-to-medium B2B marketing agency (SME), early transformation phase. Red Panda Works is making a genuine AI-first bet in 2026 with a small core team. The company is building, not maintaining - the mandate is to define how AI will be used across four delivery teams from scratch. This is a growth context, not a steady-state one.

Culture signals: The JD language is action-oriented and outcome-focused. Salary transparency, a three-stage hiring process, and specific metrics (CSAT, NPS) suggest an organized but lean operation that values accountability. The "AI-first in 2026" framing is explicit - this is not a company paying lip service to AI adoption; it is making a structural change that requires a builder.

Physical/work environment: Amsterdam hybrid (Johan Huizingalaan 763A). Small agency office, not a large corporate campus. The physical context is closer to a studio or small team workspace. 40 minutes from Baarn by train - manageable.

Match against 2-year vision: The 2-year vision is a hackerspace: small group, building new things, high trust, new territory. Red Panda Works scores moderately against this. The company is small, the mandate is a genuine build-from-scratch, and the AI-first bet signals frontier thinking. The gap is that it is a marketing agency - the domain is commercial delivery, not pure innovation or learning. The building mandate is real but the "new territory" dimension is limited to AI adoption within a defined commercial context.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Strong 0 to 1 (build the AI layer from scratch) with ongoing management after	ENFP-T starter, strongest 0 to 1 and 1 to 2	Good for the build phase; risk after stabilization
Variety vs. repetition	Variety across 4 teams and evolving AI landscape; some repetition in CSAT/NPS tracking	Thrives on variety, drains fast on repetition	Good - variety is structural
Autonomy level	High: "own all AI systems, SOPs, skill library, prompts" - genuine ownership mandate	Needs ownership and design authority	Strong match
Build vs. maintain	Build-heavy initially, then ongoing maintenance of what was built	Builder identity - maintenance depletes	Good for 12 to 18 months; plateau risk after systems

		energy	stabilize
Fractional fit	Full-time (Head-of role, 5 days/week implied)	Optimal: 2 to 3 concurrent 0.4 to 0.6 FTE	Fractional conflict - this expects full-time focus
Energy spike tolerance	Small agency - founders likely welcome energy and initiative in early months	Front-loaded high energy in first weeks	Good match for an SME entering a transformation
Team size	Small agency with 4 delivery teams - total team likely under 50 people	Small team, high trust preference	Good match

Flag: Full-time exclusivity expected (fractional conflict). This is a Head-of role - RPW will expect primary commitment.

H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

Red Panda Works is a commercial marketing agency. The mission is client delivery, not a frontier cause Christiaan would engage with intrinsically. However, the specific mandate - being the person who defines how an entire agency goes AI-first in 2026 - connects to what Christiaan genuinely cares about: building learning environments, making technology stick with people who are skeptical or new to it, and leaving a system behind that runs without him.

The work is not mission-driven in the way a sustainability lab or education innovation role would be. But the "founding moment" quality - being the architect of something that will run for years - is an authentic energizer. He would talk about this work at a dinner party if the conversation was about AI adoption. He probably would not talk about B2B marketing campaigns.

This is a moderate intrinsic connection, not a strong one. Valid to pursue for the founding-moment opportunity, the skill development in a commercial context, and the compensation, but not as a long-term career home.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers for this role:

- Genuine build-from-scratch mandate for the AI layer
- Small team, direct visibility of impact
- Claude-first stack aligns with daily working reality
- Training and adoption facilitation across four teams - core to what Christiaan does for free
- Something to architect that will outlast the initial build phase

Likely drains:

- Once the AI stack is stable, the role shifts toward maintenance and CSAT tracking
- B2B marketing domain is not intrinsically exciting - the domain is the delivery context, not the frontier
- Full-time exclusivity prevents stacking alongside other engagements
- CSAT and NPS ownership introduces a pressure dynamic more familiar from client service than from building
- Agency pace may eventually feel repetitive once the AI layer is established

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Rating: Short-term fit with plateau risk after build phase.

The first 12 months at Red Panda Works would be genuinely energizing: architect the AI stack, train four teams, define the SOPs, establish the quality standards. This is exactly Christiaan's strongest operating mode. The risk emerges at month 12 to 18, when the systems are running and the role shifts toward optimization, CSAT monitoring, and incremental iteration. At that point, without a new build mandate, engagement will drop. The role is sustainable as a medium-term engagement (12 to 18 months) but is not a long-term home unless RPW continues to grow and creates new building opportunities.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	Partially, after build phase	Medium	First 12 months is build; then it becomes maintenance of the built system
Solo sales of an unready product	No	n/a	Not a sales role

Full-time exclusivity expected	Yes	Medium	Head-of role at an SME - full-time commitment is implicit
Large corporate, slow decision cycles	No	n/a	Small agency, fast decision cycles
Governance/board role in declining org	No	n/a	Growth context
Ceremony-only Scrum Master	No	n/a	Not a Scrum role

H7 - Fit Verdict

The honest case for this match:

This is a genuine build-from-scratch mandate at a small company making an AI-first bet. Christiaan arrives with a live AI stack, a proven adoption methodology, and 15+ years of doing exactly what the JD asks. The team is small enough that his contributions will be immediately visible. The Claude-first framing matches his daily working reality. The energy spike reads as an asset in a small agency entering transformation. The founding-moment quality is real: whoever architects RPW's AI layer in 2026 will have built something that matters. For a medium-term engagement, this is one of the better matches in the batch.

The honest case against:

The agency domain is not intrinsically motivating - the work is commercial delivery optimization, not frontier innovation. The full-time exclusivity conflicts with the multi-engagement model. After the initial build phase (12 to 18 months), the role risks shifting to maintenance of what was built, which is exactly where Christiaan's energy drops. The salary ceiling (€84k at the high end) is within range but below what this seniority level should command in the market. The culture fit is good for the build phase and moderate for the long term.

Overall personality/culture fit: Moderate

Note: Score of 3.8/5 is appropriate. The strong skill match carries the score. The culture fit is genuine but time-limited. Apply with a clear internal sense of the 12 to 18 month horizon.

KEYWORDS

AI systems, Claude, Claude Code, AI-first, AI transformation, delivery management, team lead, SOPs, skill library, prompt engineering, AI fluency, innovation, quality ownership, CSAT, NPS, training, documentation, standardization, B2B marketing, Amsterdam, Head of AI, n8n, Flowise, OpenWebUI, self-hosted AI